Competitor watch · Q1 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q1 2026 trading update**	**771.9 EUR**	**−0.8%**	**+2.8%**	**14.2%**	**+60 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q1 2026 trading update	–	+6.0%	+5.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q1 2026 results	2,125 USD	+2.7%	0.0%	20.6%	+20 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q1 2026 results	4,066 USD	+10.0%	+4.0%	16.7%	+70 bps	Adj. operating margin
Watts	Q1 2026 results	677.3 USD	+21.4%	+11.9%	20.1%	+110 bps	Adj. operating margin
Emerson*	Q1 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2025)	4,346 USD	+4.1%	+2.0%	27.7%	−30 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q1 2026 results	1,037 USD	+2.6%	+1.1%	25.0%	+100 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						

Reported margin comparison

Aalberts		**14.2%** +60 bps EBITA margin
IMI	no margin disclosed	
Belimo	no report	
Xylem		**20.6%** +20 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab		**16.7%** +70 bps Adj. operating margin
Watts		**20.1%** +110 bps Adj. operating margin
Emerson*		**27.7%** −30 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair		**25.0%** +100 bps Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report	

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · Q1 2026 trading update

Revenue **771.9** EUR m (−0.8% reported) · Organic growth **+2.8%** · EBITA margin **14.2%** +60 bps

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	369.4	−9.6%	+1.3%	14.5% (13.2%)	High organic growth in the USA; Europe weak (France, Germany); data-centre order book growing
Industry	247.9	−5.6%	+5.8%	17.1% (16.3%)	Business development and geographical expansion
Semicon	159.0	+42.5%	+2.2%	13.3% (10.0%)	Revenue +42% incl. acquisitions

Segment growth: Growth returned in all three segments: industry +5.8% organic, semicon +2.2% (revenue +42% with acquisitions, EBITA almost doubled), building +1.3% with margin +130 bps to 14.5% despite divestments (revenue −10%).

Outlook: Further improvement in organic growth and EBITA margin expected in 2026.

Source: Q1 2026 press release (PDF)

IMI · Q1 2026 trading update

Revenue not reported in this update · Organic growth **+5.0%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	–	–	+6.0%		
Process Automation	–	–	+6.0%		Orders −2% against a strong comparator; aftermarket orders −1%
Industrial Automation	–	–	+6.0%		Easier comparator after the Q1 2025 cyber incident
Life Technology	–	–	+4.0%		
Climate Control	–	–	+4.0%		Strength in data-centre direct liquid cooling
Life Science & Fluid Control	–	–	+1.0%		Resilient healthcare; mixed Fluid Control
Transport	–	–	+9.0%		In line with heavy-duty truck market; strategic review progressing

Segment growth: Organic growth across all six business lines. Automation +6% (Process and Industrial both +6%); Life Technology +4% with Transport +9% and Climate Control +4%. Middle East = 6% of 2025 revenue; limited impact on orders and sales so far.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. basic EPS 136p–142p reconfirmed; sixth year of mid-single-digit organic growth on track.

Source: Q1 2026 trading update (PDF)

Xylem · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **2,125** USD m (+2.7% reported) · Organic growth **0.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **20.6%** +20 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.12** (+9% vs $1.03) · Free cash flow **18** (−38 a year earlier) · Orders **2,228** (0% organic; +3% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	603.0	+3.8%	−1.0%	21.9% (20.7%)	Orders 675 (+2% organic)
Applied Water	448.0	+3.0%	0.0%	19.6% (19.5%)	Orders 512 (+2% organic)
Measurement & Control Solutions	508.0	+3.7%	+1.0%	20.9% (21.0%)	Orders 475 (+15% organic)
Water Solutions & Services	566.0	+0.5%	−2.0%	22.1% (21.7%)	Orders 566 (-15% organic)

Segment growth: Revenue flat organically; strength in energy metering, dewatering, transport and building solutions offset declines. MCS orders +15%. Margins up in WI (+120 bps) and WSS (+40 bps).

Source: Q1 2026 earnings package (PDF) · Q1 2026 earnings release

Ecolab · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **4,066** USD m (+10.0% reported) · Organic growth **+4.0%** · Adj. operating margin **16.7%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.70** (+13%; GAAP $1.52)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	2,035	+7.1%	+2.0%	14.6% (14.7%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+5.0%		
Heavy Water	–	–	−2.0%		
High-Tech	–	–	+25.0%		+131% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Light Water	–	–	+2.0%		
Paper	–	–	−2.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,508	+3.6%	+4.0%	23.0% (21.2%)	
Institutional	–	–	+2.0%		
Specialty	–	–	+9.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	310.1	+7.9%	+7.0%	16.7% (16.6%)	
Global Life Sciences	200.9	+10.7%	+11.0%	18.7% (17.1%)	

Segment growth: Growth engines accelerated: High-Tech +25% organic (+131% with Ovivo), Life Sciences +11% (bioprocessing doubled), Pest +7%. Water +2% as Paper and Heavy Water stabilised. Institutional & Specialty OI +13%, margin +180 bps to 23.0%.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS $8.43–8.63 (+12% to 15%) excl. CoolIT; organic growth 2H +6% to 7%; adj. OI margin ~19%; Q2 $2.02–2.12.

Source: Q1 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Watts · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **677.3** USD m (+21.4% reported) · Organic growth **+11.9%** · Adj. operating margin **20.1%** +110 bps · Adj. EPS **$3.04** (+28%) · Free cash flow **7** (46 in Q1 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Americas	515.1	+23.2%	+15.5%	24.2% (23.4%)	Price and data-centre volume; acquisitions +USD 30.7m; segment earnings +26.9% organic
Europe	121.4	+12.0%	+0.5%	13.8% (13.9%)	segment earnings -0.7% organic
APMEA	40.8	+29.5%	+3.4%	18.4% (17.5%)	Acquisitions +USD 5.9m; segment earnings +56.4% organic

Segment growth: Organic +11.9%: Americas +15.5% on price and data-centre volume; Europe +0.5%, APMEA +3.4%. Acquisitions added 6.6 pts. Americas segment earnings +27% organic; GAAP operating income +52%.

Outlook: Full-year 2026 outlook maintained.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF) · Q1 2026 earnings release

Emerson* · Q1 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2025)

Revenue **4,346** USD m (+4.1% reported) · Underlying growth **+2.0%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **27.7%** −30 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.46** (+6% vs $1.38; GAAP $1.07) · Free cash flow **602** (−13%) · Underlying orders **+9%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Software & Systems	1,453	+5.1%	+3.0%	31.3% (31.1%)	
Control Systems & Software	1,044	+2.1%	0.0%		Power and life sciences offset by software-renewal timing
Test & Measurement	409.0	+13.9%	+11.0%		Aerospace & defence, semiconductor
Intelligent Devices	2,390	+3.6%	+2.0%	26.9% (27.6%)	
Sensors	996.0	+2.5%	+1.0%		
Final Control	1,394	+4.5%	+2.0%		Power, Americas
Safety & Productivity	503.0	+3.3%	+1.0%	20.9% (21.3%)	
REGIONS					
Americas	2,201	+3.6%	+3.0%		US +6%
Asia, Middle East & Africa	1,273	−0.2%	0.0%		China −5%
Europe	872.0	+12.4%	+3.0%		

Segment growth: New structure from fiscal 2026 (prior year restated). Test & Measurement +11% underlying (aerospace & defence, semiconductor); Software & Systems margin 31.3% despite ~2 pts drag from software-renewal timing. Intelligent Devices +2%, margin −70 bps; Safety & Productivity +1%.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. EPS midpoint raised: $6.40–6.55.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **1,037** USD m (+2.6% reported) · Core sales growth **+1.1%** · Adj. return on sales **25.0%** +100 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.22** (+10%)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	258.1	+11.0%	+2.5%	23.7% (21.6%)	Incl. Hydra-Stop (+4.3 pts acquisitions)
Water Solutions	391.0	−0.6%	+0.9%	25.5% (23.9%)	
Pool	387.1	+0.8%	+0.5%	33.1% (32.8%)	

Segment growth: New segment structure from 1 Jan 2026 (residential and irrigation flow moved from Flow to Water Solutions; prior year restated). Core +1.1% on price +5.3% and volume −4.2%. Flow segment income +22% (ROS 23.7%), Water Solutions +6% (ROS 25.5%), Pool +2%.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS raised to $5.30–5.40.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).